

**Superior Court of the State of California  
County of Orange**

**DEPT C20 TENTATIVE RULINGS**

**Judge Theodore Howard**

The court will hear oral argument on all matters at the time noticed for the hearing. If you would prefer to submit the matter on your papers without oral argument, please advise the clerk by calling (657) 622-5220. If no appearance is made by either party, the tentative ruling will be the final ruling. Rulings are normally posted on the Internet by 4:00 p.m. on the day before the hearing.

**COURT REPORTERS WILL NO LONGER BE PROVIDED FOR TRIAL AND OTHER HEARINGS WHERE LIVE EVIDENCE WILL BE PRESENTED. IF A PARTY DESIRES A COURT REPORTER FOR ANY HEARING INCLUDING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO, LAW AND MOTION MATTERS, EX PARTE MATTERS AND CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCES, IT WILL BE THE RESPONSIBILITY OF THAT PARTY TO PROVIDE ITS OWN COURT REPORTER. PARTIES MUST COMPLY WITH THE COURT'S POLICY ON THE USE OF PRO TEMPORE COURT REPORTERS WHICH CAN BE FOUND ON THE COURT'S WEBSITE AT:**

[http://www.occourts.org/media/pdf/7-25-2014 Privately Retained Court Reporter Policy.pdf](http://www.occourts.org/media/pdf/7-25-2014%20Privately%20Retained%20Court%20Reporter%20Policy.pdf)

**The Orange County Superior Court has implemented administrative orders, policies, and procedures noted on the Court's website to address the limitations and restrictions presented during the COVID-19 pandemic at Civil Covid-19. Due to the fluid nature of this crisis, you are encouraged to frequently check the Court's website at <https://www.occourts.org> for the most up to date information relating to Civil Operations.**

Unless otherwise ordered by the Court, all Unlimited and Complex proceedings may be conducted via Zoom or in person. On the date of your hearing click the Department C20 Link to begin the remote online check in/Zoom appearance process:

<https://occourtsapp.occourts.org/aci/checkin-results?dept=C20>

**Date: September 24, 2026**

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| 1. | Torres v. Nissan North America, Inc.<br>25-1466350 | <p>Before the court is the unopposed Motion to be Relieved as Counsel of Record, filed by attorney Mani Arabi of Strategic Legal Practices, APC as to the representation of plaintiff Isabel C. Torres. The motion is <b>DENIED</b> without prejudice.</p> <p><i>California Rule of Court, rule 3.1362(d)</i> provides, "[t]he notice of motion and motion, the declaration, and the proposed order must be</p> |

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|    |                                                   | <p>served on the client and on all other parties who have appeared in the case.” Here, there is no proof of service showing service of the moving papers on the client. The motion is therefore <b>DENIED</b>, without prejudice.</p> <p><i>Moving counsel is ordered to give notice of this ruling.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2. | Yoon v. Ross Stores, Inc.<br>25-1538080           | <p>Before the court is an unopposed motion filed by attorney Brian W. Lee requesting to be relieved as counsel of record for plaintiff Jung Ho Yoon (“Client”). The motion is <b>DENIED</b> without prejudice.</p> <p><i>California Rule of Court, rule 3.1362(d)</i> provides, “[t]he notice of motion and motion, the declaration, and the proposed order must be served on the client and on all other parties who have appeared in the case.” There is no proof of service showing service of the moving papers on either the client or opposing counsel. As such, counsel has failed to comply with <i>Rule 3.1362(d)</i>. The motion is therefore <b>DENIED</b>, without prejudice.</p> <p>The Court also notes that in the caption of the Motion (ROA 30) Lee states that he is counsel for “Judy Cho an individual aka Yoon Jeon.” However, in the body of the motion, he states that he is seeking to be relieved as counsel for “Jung Ho Yoon.” Any future motion should correct this inconsistency.</p> <p><i>Mr. Lee is ordered to give notice of this ruling and to file the proof of service with the Court.</i></p> |
| 3. | Bravo v. Nissan North America, Inc.<br>25-1471170 | <p>The unopposed Motion to be Relieved as Counsel of Record, filed by attorney Mani Arabi of Strategic Legal Practices, APC as to the representation of plaintiff Salomon Bustos Bravo is <b>GRANTED</b>.</p> <p>The Court finds the motion, declaration and proposed order comply with <i>Rule 3.1662</i>. The Order will become effective upon filing of a proof of service reflecting service of the resulting Order on the client.</p> <p><i>Moving counsel is ordered to give notice of this ruling.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 4. | Cicale v. LoanDepot.com, LLC<br>26-1544409        | <p>Before the Court is the unopposed application of attorney Erin Tuck to appear in this matter <i>pro hac vice</i> as counsel for plaintiffs.</p> <p>Moving counsel has complied with the requirements set forth in <i>California Rules of Court, Rule 9.40</i>. Accordingly, the application is <b>GRANTED</b>.</p> <p><i>Counsel for plaintiffs is ordered to give notice of this ruling.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 5. | Kammoun v. Bali<br>26-1564261                     | <p>Plaintiff Hela Kammoun’s motion for leave to file a second amended complaint is <b>DENIED</b> without prejudice.</p> <p>The motion fails to comply with the requirements of <i>California Rules of Court, rule 3.1324</i>, including submissions of a proposed amended pleading and a separate declaration containing the requisite information. (<i>Cal. Rules of Court, rule 3.1324(a),(b).</i>)</p> <p><i>Plaintiff shall give notice of this ruling.</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |